



Network and Cloud Monitoring *with* **Nagios**

This article focuses on the open source network- and infrastructure-monitoring tool, Nagios.

Computers on a network share resources and information with each other. Network monitoring involves the supervision of network operations using various products to ensure performance and the availability of network services by reporting failures. Network management refers to the actions, procedures and tools that are related to keeping network services up and running, tracking resources, performing upgrades, and configuring the resources of networked systems. Network management is a superset of network monitoring. It provides monitoring and reporting for network services as well as for host resources such as logs, storage and processor usage. It monitors IT infrastructure, detects problems before they occur, and alerts humans.

The network- and infrastructure-monitoring tool, Nagios, is used to monitor publicly available services and more. Nagios is very useful for SMBs. Effective usage of Nagios ensures issue tracking in a timely manner. SLAs, which are critical in today's IT world, can be met effectively, ensuring that outages have minimal effect on the organisation's IT infrastructure.

Nagios Core

Nagios Core is the open source base for Nagios XI—a commercial monitoring solution. To run Nagios Core, you need a machine running Linux or a UNIX variant, and network accessibility, as basic pre-requisites. Nagios Core allows you to monitor your entire IT infrastructure to ensure that resources, applications, services and business processes function appropriately. In the event of a failure, it can alert technical staff of the problem in a timely manner, which allows them to commence remedial action before outages affect business processes, end users or customers. Nagios Core is licensed under the GNU General Public License. There are multiple online resources related to it. The Nagios support forums, support portal and community mailing lists are very useful.

Features

Nagios' deep insight into infrastructure, and its detailed reports on the status of resources, services and other components—availability reports, historical reports